

PHOTO: AAJ TAK



**STUNG:** Jothikumaran

take the money in cash totalling Rs 2 lakh has not been satisfactorily explained.

Jothikumaran is widely regarded as the power behind the IHF's autocrat-President K.P.S. Gill's reign at the head of Indian hockey since 1994. He rose to prominence from modest beginnings as a State Bank of India clerk into Gill's confidant and ally, managing poll numbers for Gill. Many, including players, believe Jothikumaran was the one who called the shots but was smart enough to let Gill face the fire.

Recently, the two equally abhorrent faces of the IHF have had a falling out. The furore caused by the Jothikumaran sting is nothing compared to what could happen if the Indian Olympic Association decides to derecognise the IHF for maladministration. If that day does dawn, it will not come a moment too soon. **by Sharda Ugra**

## Caught in the Act

**DELHI** Talk about a feeble defence. This has nothing to do with the Indian hockey team and the Surrender of Santiago—when they failed to qualify for the Olympics for the first time in 80 years. The weak defence came from the Indian Hockey

Federation's (IHF) all-powerful secretary-general Kandaswamy Jothikumaran who was caught with his hands in the till—on camera.

A sting operation by the Aaj Tak channel, which is owned by the INDIA TODAY Group—

featured Jothikumaran accepting cash in exchange to allegedly have a player selected on the Indian team. The sting operators had posed as businessmen trying to stage an international hockey tournament. Naturally, Jothikumaran claimed the money was to meet "initial expenses" for organising the event. Just why he was so keen to

## THE BUZZ OF THE WEEK

Though the Government may be loathe to admit it, here is proof that it has kissed the Indo-US nuke deal goodbye. After delaying it for months, it is finally readying to roll out the red carpet for Iranian President Mahmoud Ahmadinejad.

## VOICES



"In ancient India, a monarch was a good king if he did not interfere too much in the life of the people. That has been our guiding principle as well."

Manmohan Singh, prime minister

"If there is a *yuvraj* (prince), there has to be a *rajmata* (queen) and a maharaja. Such a concept in a democratic country has to be a joke."

Balbir Punj, BJP Rajya Sabha member

"There would be a time when (India and Pakistan) would feel Partition has not solved matters. Why not come together and form some sort of confederation?"

L.K. Advani, leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha

"Amitabh Bachchan, Lata Mangeshkar and Dilip Kumar are legends and Indians are known worldwide because of them. It's better not to drag them into petty politics."

Govinda, Congress MP and actor

"With so much cricket being played, it's already taking its toll on players' fitness. Earlier, a player could play for 10-15 years or more, but now that thing is going to change."

Roger Binny, former cricketer

